

6.1 Getting Set To Record

There are a few things you need to have in order to be able to record sound to your hard drive. For starters, you need to have a sound card with microphone and line-in input jacks. If you're looking to record voice, you will need a microphone, or else, if you're looking to record from another audio source, you will need to have another player that can play back as a source for the audio.

Remember the days of the audio cassette? So many of us have such rare and cherished collections on audio cassettes, but don't have cassette decks (or players) anymore! Some of the albums we have aren't even available anymore, on CD or on the Net. So what can you do? Simple: just clean up your old cassette deck, connect its output to the line-in of the computer, and start recording!

We'll walk you through that a little later, but for now, you've already found one good reason to learn how to record to your computer.

Another very good reason, especially for journalists, is when you interview someone and use a mini cassette voice recorder. Often, the volume of the recorded voice is too soft, and there's too much noise in the background. The simplest thing to do would be to record it to the PC and then use an editor such as Audacity to clean it up and make it louder.

Then of course there's the case of wanting to record your voice or musical instrument to the PC...

6.1.1 Setting Up

If you just bought yourself a sound card and are looking to record from any type of audio source, you need to first set up your computer for sound. If you haven't read through the previous chapter on how to set up the audio editing PC, you should do so now.